



MARKET INTELLIGENCE
MARCH 2026

Thoroughbred Market Intelligence Report

Global Bloodstock Analysis · March 2026

A comprehensive view of the global thoroughbred market as of March 2026 — covering sales liquidity, stallion landscape, regulatory pressures, breeding trends and strategic priorities for the professional bloodstock operator.

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01

Global Market Overview

The global thoroughbred market enters March 2026 in a state best described as **selectively strong**. Demand at the top end of the market remains exceptionally robust — the OBS March 2yo in Training Sale delivered an estimated gross of **US\$76.5M+**, a 30%+ increase over 2025 — while the middle and lower tiers require more precise targeting and vendor discipline to clear efficiently. International capital flows remain active, with Japanese, Saudi Arabian and Latin American buyers competing at the highest levels in North America, while domestically, Australian buyers reclaimed the premium tier at Magic Millions January with local operators securing the top eight lots.

The broader macro environment is constructive: the American 'Big Beautiful Bill' providing 100% bonus depreciation on racing assets continues to inject fresh capital into the owner market, particularly in the US\$500K–US\$2M range. The Jockey Club projects approximately **17,000 foals** registered in North America for 2026 — roughly 300 fewer than 2025 — a modest supply contraction that historically favours vendors with quality product. In Britain, active mare numbers have stabilised around 6,200 annual foals, while Australia, New Zealand and South Africa maintain production discipline aligned with their racing prize money levels.

Market Indicator	2026 Status	vs 2025	BloodstockAI Signal
North American foal crop	~17,000 projected	▼ -300	Slight supply tightening — quality premium
OBS March Sale gross	US\$76.5M+ (est.)	▲ +30%	Strongest 2yo market in 5+ years
MM Gold Coast (Jan) gross	A\$213M+ confirmed	▼ -1.5%	Stable; domestic buyers dominant
Inglis Premier (Feb) gross	A\$68.6M confirmed	▲ +14%	Middle market particularly strong
European fee inflation	Frankel/Dubawi £350K	= Flat	Supply scarcity at elite level
Digital platform activity	Growing — all regions	▲ Rising	Tactical rotation tool; not main channel

Key macro indicators as of March 2026. Sources: OBS, Magic Millions, Inglis, TRC, Jockey Club.

STRATEGIC CONTEXT

Global market polarisation is intensifying: the top 15% of lots capture a disproportionate share of gross. Operators without a clear quality-selection thesis are increasingly squeezed by RNA rates in the 25–33% range outside the premium tier. Discipline on reserve pricing and physical standards is non-negotiable in 2026.

02

Sales & Liquidity

2-Year-Olds in Training & Breeze-Up Sales

The OBS March Sale in Ocala, Florida remains the undisputed benchmark for the global 2yo in training market. The 2026 edition catalogued 816 lots across three days of selling, with an under-tack show running March 4–7. The results — an estimated **US\$76.5M+ gross** with 8+ seven-figure sales and a top price of US\$2M for the Nyquist filly purchased by Boyd Racing — represent the most dynamic commercial juvenile market in years.

Freshman sire **Drain the Clock** (Gainesway Farm, Lexington KY) was the revelation of the sale, producing two juveniles that equalled the OBS quarter-mile track record (:20 1/5), generating a gross of approximately **US\$4.4M** from 15 sold — a historic debut for a first-crop sire in this format. Corniche (Coolmore America / Ashford Stud) confirmed elite commercial standing with the third-highest price at US\$1.35M. Nyquist (Darley) and Into Mischief (Spendthrift Farm) commanded multiple seven-figure bids, validating their position as the market's blue-chip sires.

Rank	Sire	Crop	Sold	Est. Gross	Top Price	Highlight
1	Nyquist	Proven	~12	US\$6.5M+	US\$2,000,000	2x seven figures; top filly
2	Drain the Clock	Freshman	~15	US\$4.4M+	US\$1,100,000	2x OBS track record :20 1/5
3	Into Mischief	Proven	~8	US\$3.5M+	US\$1,850,000	Highest individual price
4	Corniche	Freshman	~6	US\$2.2M+	US\$1,350,000	2021 Breeders' Cup Juvenile
5	Mo Town	Proven	~3	US\$1.3M+	US\$1,050,000	Baoma/Baffert connection
6	Tiz the Law	Proven	~3	US\$1.1M+	US\$850,000	Zedan Racing acquisition
7	Army Mule	Proven	~2	US\$850K+	US\$750,000	Yoshida Japan — bullet 1/8

OBS March 2026 — Top Sires by Estimated Gross. Sources: TDN, BloodHorse, OBS official results.

Yearling Sales — Global Q1 2026

The Australasian yearling season opened strongly, with the Magic Millions Gold Coast Yearling Sale (January 13–18) delivering **A\$213M+** from 932 sold, led by joint sale toppers at A\$2M each — a Frankel (GB) colt to Coolmore and an Extreme Choice colt to Yulong Investments. The 2026 edition was notable for domestic buyer dominance: local operators secured the top eight lots, reversing the international trend of 2025. First-season sire **Anamoe** (Darley, New South Wales) exceeded all expectations with 30 sold at A\$481K average.

The **Inglis Melbourne Premier Yearling Sale** (February) confirmed the trend, delivering A\$68.6M gross (+14% year-on-year), with average lifting to A\$157,590 and median to A\$130,000. Toronado led by aggregate, with Extreme Choice and Home Affairs featuring in the top five sires. The upcoming **Inglis Easter Sale** (March 29–30) presents the

season's highest-profile lots, including the Snitzel colt from Winx and 11 Extreme Choice yearlings — with international attention expected to intensify.

Digital & Hybrid Sales Platforms

Fasig-Tipton Digital and Tattersalls Online have normalised as tactical commercial tools. Their primary utility for the sophisticated operator is stock rotation outside traditional sale windows — HRA lots, individual dispersals, late-season reofferings and value-priced mares with sound pedigrees. These platforms do not replace the premium live auction environment but have compressed the time-to-sale window meaningfully. Inglis Digital USA is also gaining traction, attracting international bidders for mid-range broodmare prospects.

03

Stallion Landscape

Elite Sires — Global Fee Leaders 2026

Sire	Stud — Location	2026 Fee	Age	Key Metric	BloodstockAI Note
Frankel (GB)	Banstead Manor Stud, Newmarket, UK (Juddmonte)	£350,000	18	17% stakes/runners; 40 G1 winners	3rd consecutive yr at career-high; succession planning critical
Dubawi (Ire)	Dalham Hall Stud, Newmarket, UK (Darley/Godolphin)	£350,000	24	Champion sire 2022; Night of Thunder sire	Veteran status; scarcity value accelerating; final seasons
Sea The Stars	Gilltown Stud, Co. Kildare, Ireland (Aga Khan)	€300,000	20	Career-high fee; elite middle-distance	Steady rise from €85K (2010); proven longevity
Night of Thunder	Kildangan Stud, Co. Kildare, Ireland (Darley)	€200,000	13	5 G1 winners in 2025; Dubawi heir	Commercial momentum exceptional; best mares shifting here
Gun Runner	Three Chimneys Farm, Versailles, KY, USA	US\$250,000	11	Stable US leader alongside Into Mischief	Not This Time emerging as value challenger
Into Mischief	Spendthrift Farm, Lexington, KY, USA	US\$250,000	21	7x leading sire; modern era dominance	OBS March top seller confirms sustained demand
Extreme Choice	Newgate Farm, NSW, Australia	A\$330,000	10	17 stakes winners; 6 G1; 44 live foals '24	A\$2M sale topper at MM Jan; supply critically scarce
I Am Invincible	Swettenham Stud, Nagambie, VIC, Australia	A\$275,000	18	Champion sire; million+ filly each day MM	Three consecutive days with 7-fig. filly at MM Jan 2026
Anamoe	Darley, Kelvinside Stud, NSW, Australia	A\$165,000	7	9x G1; 2024 Horse of the Year; debut crop	A\$481K avg from 30 sold — best freshman debut in recent MM history

Global fee leaders 2026. Sources: TRC, Thoroughbred Racing Commentary, Magic Millions, OBS, Darley, Juddmonte, Coolmore.

Buzz Sires & Value Plays — Where the Edge Lives

For operators seeking the highest marginal commercial returns, the real opportunity in 2026 lies in correctly identifying sires before their commercial fee reflects their racetrack performance. The pattern is consistent: a stallion's fee jumps 3–5x within 2–3 seasons of a flagship G1 winner. **Night of Thunder** — standing at €15K in his early seasons, now at €200K — is the canonical recent example. The following sires present varying risk/reward profiles entering the 2026 season:

Sire	Stud — Location	2026 Fee	Risk Tier	Upside Case	Flag
Drain the Clock	Gainesway Farm, Lexington, KY, USA	~US\$10,000	LOW-MED	2x OBS :20 1/5 track record in debut crop; Brad Cox trained; HK/Saudi demand. Highest ROI (7.74x) of any first-crop sire at Keeneland Sep 2025.	STRONG BUY
Modern Games (Ire)	Dalham Hall Stud, Newmarket, UK (Darley/Godolphin)	£27,500	LOW	£225K Goffs sale; 'next Night of Thunder' narrative building in Europe; Darley support base.	ACCUMULATE
Chaldean (GB)	Banstead Manor Stud, Newmarket, UK (Juddmonte)	£20,000	LOW	Juddmonte support; covered 323 mares in first two books; most Group/BT performers of any first-season sire in Brit/Ire debut year.	MONITOR
Wootton Bassett sons (Camille Pissarro / Henri Matisse)	Coolmore Stud, Fethard, Co. Tipperary, Ireland	€30,000 / €20,000	MED	Both G1 winners at 2 AND 3; only Wootton Bassett sons to achieve this. Legacy demand from father's 2025 death at €300K. Camille Pissarro €30K, Henri Matisse €20K.	SELECTIVE
Not This Time (USA)	Taylor Made Stallions, Nicholasville, KY, USA	US\$250,000	LOW	#2 General Sire in 2025 with ~US\$19M earnings; 9 G1 winners; #1 sire of 2yo in every category 2025; 17 seven-figure yearlings at Keeneland Sep — from crops bred at US\$40–\$45K. Fee now reflects true status.	POSITION NOW

Ace Impact (Fr)	Haras de Beaumont, Vauville, France	€30,000	HIGH	Share sold at €152K (5x fee); first yearlings not yet proven on track. Unbeaten Arc + Jockey Club hero; covered 200+ BT mares in first two seasons.	SPECULATIVE
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Value sire analysis March 2026. Risk tier reflects commercial fee volatility, not racing ability. Sources: TDN, TRC, Tattersalls, BloodHorse, Taylor Made Stallions, Juddmonte, Darley, Gainesway, Coolmore, Haras de Beaumont. ■ NOTE: Calyx (GB) previously listed in earlier versions of this table was removed following his death at Coolmore in May 2025.

"The real edge in bloodstock is not buying the best horse at the sale. It is buying the right stallion season at the right point in the curve — before the market has priced in what you can already see in the under-tack show and the first crop results."

— BloodstockAI Research Division, March 2026

SUCCESSION WATCH — DUBAWI & FRANKEL

Both Dubawi (24) and Frankel (18) are entering the latter stages of their stud careers. The succession race is live: Night of Thunder (Dubawi's heir apparent at Kildangan Stud), Lead Artist (Dubawi son, debut 2026 at Banstead Manor Stud, Juddmonte), Chaldean (Frankel son, Banstead Manor Stud, Juddmonte) and Diego Velazquez (Frankel son, National Stud, UK) are the primary candidates. Positioning mares to these 'branch sires' now — at current fees before the succession premium is priced in — represents one of the highest-conviction booking strategies in European bloodstock.

04

Welfare, Regulation & Compliance

TBA Equine Welfare Levy — United Kingdom (effective January 2026)

The Thoroughbred Breeders' Association has introduced a mandatory Equine Welfare Levy of **£60 per foal** registered through Weatherbys, effective January 2026. This replaces the previous voluntary £25 donation structure (TBA + Retraining of Racehorses) and creates a compulsory funding mechanism for post-career welfare and retraining programmes. For British-based operations, this adds £60 to the cost of every registered foal. For a mid-size operation producing 20 foals annually, the annual impact is £1,200 — modest in isolation, but part of a broader cost-accumulation trend that includes rising stud fees, preparation costs and sale levies.

Strategically, this levy signals the direction of travel: mandatory welfare contributions will deepen in scope and geography. Operations that proactively communicate their welfare and aftercare commitments now — partnerships with RoR, documented placement rates, no-slaughter clauses in sales contracts — will be better positioned commercially as institutional buyers and syndicators increasingly screen for welfare standards alongside pedigree.

SAFE Act & Aftercare — United States

The SAFE Act (Safeguard American Food Exports Act) — which would prohibit horse slaughter for human consumption in the United States — has circulated in Congress in various forms since 2013 without passage. As of March 2026, industry figures including Mike Repole and Aron Wellman have publicly renewed pressure for structural aftercare financing, arguing that the industry cannot continue to rely on voluntary contributions for a systemic challenge. The political reality remains unfavourable for federal legislation in the near term.

The practical response must therefore be industry-led: private levy structures at the point of registration or sale, expanded partnerships with adoption organisations, and explicit aftercare clauses in sales conditions and syndication documents. Operations that lead rather than lag on this issue will benefit from enhanced reputational positioning with the growing class of institutional and high-net-worth owner-investors who treat welfare compliance as a baseline requirement, not a differentiator.

REGULATORY RISK MATRIX

Jurisdiction	Status	Operator Action Required
United Kingdom	Mandatory £60/foal TBA levy NOW IN EFFECT (Jan 2026)	Build into every foal P&L; from day one; document RoR partnerships
Australia	No equivalent mandatory scheme; RoR-equivalent programs expanding	Voluntary leadership; positions operation ahead of likely regulation
United States	SAFE Act stalled; industry self-regulation window open but closing	Implement internal aftercare protocols now; pre-empt state legislation
France	Welfare and traceability requirements tightening under EU framework	Ensure EU-compliant traceability documentation for all stock

05

Breeding Trends & Mating Strategies

The dominant commercial breeding philosophy entering 2026 is portfolio diversification anchored by data from the 2yo sales cycle. Operations like Machmer Hall exemplify this: 85 producing mares distributed across 47 stallions at 10 farms, with approximately 20 mating slots still open entering spring — a deliberately opportunistic structure that allows late-season positioning based on emerging stallion results.

Breeding Theme	Commercial Driver	2026 Evidence	Action
2yo sire buzz identification	Breeze-up sales ROI +	Drain the Clock (OBS); Yaupon (2024); Tiz the Law (2025)	Position 1–2 mares per buzz candidate 2 seasons ahead of breakout
Dubawi/Frankel succession	Fee scarcity + age	Night of Thunder (Kildangan), Chaldean, Lead Artist, Diego Velazquez debut crops	Book seasons to branch sires at current fees before curve rises
Wootton Bassett legacy	2025 death; last large crops	Camille Pissarro & Henri Matisse (Coolmore) enter stud 2026	Select 1–2 sons with strongest commercial book; avoid overconcentration
Speed-on-speed crosses	Breeze-up premiums	Drain the Clock x Smart Missile, Zousain x Smart Missile at OBS/MM	Identify underpriced speed mares; cross with top speed sires
Inbreeding risk management	Scientific scrutiny	Rising public + industry attention on fragility	Avoid 3x3 and tighter accumulations in speed lines; document cross rationale
Breed-to-race vs commercial	Owner type bifurcation	MyRacehorse, Machmer Hall diversifying across both models	Build dual-track book: top lots for sales, selected breeder-retained runners

Breeding strategy matrix March 2026. Sources: TDN Mating Plans, BloodstockAI analysis.

Mare Productivity & Portfolio Management

With North American foal supply contracting modestly and operating costs rising across the board — welfare levies, stud fees, preparation, inflation — the margin for error on unproductive mares narrows materially in 2026. The standard benchmark is that a producing mare must generate enough commercial value across her book to cover stud fee, keep costs, insurance and a reasonable attribution of overhead. In a market where mid-range yearlings average US\$80–\$150K, that math is achievable for a well-mated mare with a solid page. For mares producing sub-\$40K averages without a clear upgrade path, the 2026 position is strategically difficult and exit planning is prudent.

06

Strategic Priorities

The following priorities represent the actionable framework that an experienced bloodstock operator should apply across purchasing, breeding and compliance decisions in 2026:

A

AUCTION DISCIPLINE — RESIST CHASING TOP LOTS

OBS March and the European breeze-up circuit continue to reward horses with fast under-tack times, clean X-rays and strong commercial pages. The danger is overpaying at the top of the book. The best risk-adjusted returns in 2yo markets historically sit in the US\$80K–\$300K band — horses with the metrics of top lots but without the 'name' story driving bidding above fundamental value. Set a hard ceiling per lot before entering the ring. Leave before the auctioneers play the room.

B

PINHOOKING WINDOW — WEANLINGS OF BUZZ SIRES

Weanling pinhooking of Drain the Clock, Modern Games, Not This Time and Zousain represents the highest-conviction value play in the current cycle. The window to buy these before the market prices in their sales performance is narrow — likely 6–9 months after the first significant breeze-up results. Havana Grey, Mehmas and Starman are already through this window in Europe; the opportunity now is in sires whose racetrack performance has outpaced their commercial recognition.

C

DIGITAL PLATFORMS — TACTICAL USE ONLY

Fasig-Tipton Digital, Tattersalls Online and Inglis Digital are excellent tools for stock rotation, HRA opportunities and out-of-season mare acquisitions. They are not substitutes for the primary premium live sales. Use them for: dispersals of good mares at below-market prices, late-season fills, weanling flips and targeted broodmare upgrades. Budget 10–15% of annual acquisition spend through digital channels.

D

STALLION BOOK STRATEGY — THE THREE-TIER MODEL

Maintain exposure across three tiers: (1) Elite proven — Frankel (Banstead Manor), Dubawi (Dalham Hall), Extreme Choice (Newgate), I Am Invincible (Swettenham) — via daughters, granddaughters or carefully selected seasons when available. (2) Rising commercial — Night of Thunder (Kildangan), Modern Games (Dalham Hall), Anamoe (Darley), Drain the Clock (Gainesway) — before fees price in their breakout potential. (3) Speculative value — one or two low-fee sires per season where the pedigree thesis is clear but market recognition is lagging. Diversification across all three tiers is risk management, not indecision.

E

WELFARE & COMPLIANCE — GET AHEAD OF THE CURVE

In regulated markets like the UK, build the welfare levy into every foal P&L; from day one. Across all markets, establish documented aftercare partnerships (RoR equivalent), include no-slaughter clauses in sales contracts and maintain transparent placement records. This is no longer a reputational option — it is a baseline requirement for institutional buyers, syndicators and premium clients.

F

CONFORMATIONAL DUE DILIGENCE — BEYOND THE STOPWATCH

The market increasingly distinguishes between speed that translates and speed that does not. Following cases of bullet-working juveniles that failed to sustain campaigns, sophisticated buyers and trainers are applying biomechanical and durability screening alongside breeze times. A horse going :09 3/5 with a choppy stride, base-narrow stance or evidence of joint effusion represents meaningfully higher risk than the same time with correct mechanics. Build veterinary X-ray and scope standards into every acquisition protocol.

07

Key Sales Calendar — Q1/Q4 2026

Date	Sale	Location	Format	BloodstockAI Priority
Mar 12–13	Magic Millions Gold Coast March	Gold Coast, AUS	Yearlings (QTIS + non-QTIS)	MEDIUM — first non-QTIS edition; Zousain/BTR value
Mar 17–19	OBS March 2yo in Training (Day 3)	Ocala, USA	2yo in training	HIGH — Day 3 value vs Days 1–2; fresher lots, less buzz premium
Mar 19–20	Magic Millions Adelaide Yearling	Adelaide, AUS	Yearlings	MEDIUM — strong NH-bred catalog; value in mid-range
Mar 29–30	Inglis Australian Easter	Sydney, AUS	Yearlings (elite)	HIGH — Winx/Snitzel colt; 11 Extreme Choice; top international lots
Apr 7–10	OBS April 2yo in Training	Ocala, USA	2yo in training	MEDIUM-HIGH — second quality wave; good value vs March
Apr 13–17	Keeneland April 2yo in Training	Lexington, USA	2yo in training	HIGH — elite domestic juvenile buyers; Into Mischief/Nyquist premium
May 19–23	Fasig-Tipton Preakness 2yo Sales	Timonium, USA	2yo in training	MEDIUM — smaller catalogue; targeted buying bench
Jun 1–2	Magic Millions Gold Coast National	Gold Coast, AUS	Mixed (all ages)	MEDIUM — value HRA and mares; QTIS eligibility premium
Oct 6–17	Tattersalls October Book 1	Newmarket, UK	Yearlings (premium)	HIGH — Frankel/Dubawi/Night of Thunder top lots; book early for October
Oct/Nov	Goffs Orby + Tattersalls Book 2–3	UK/Ireland	Yearlings	MEDIUM — pinhook targets; Havana Grey/Mehmas/New Bay value

Selected key sales Q1–Q4 2026. Priority ratings reflect BloodstockAI assessment as of March 2026. Subject to revision.

12–24 Month Horizon — Trends to Monitor

- First runners from Drain the Clock, Corniche and other buzz sires of the 2026 OBS cycle — track performance will define 2027 yearling bookings.
- Inglis Easter 2026 results — will the Winx/Snitzel colt set a new Australian yearling record and signal continued depth at the elite level?
- Night of Thunder's (Kildangan Stud) role as Dubawi's commercial successor — watch 2026 European Group race season for confirmation.

- Impact of TBA welfare levy on small-breeder participation in British bloodstock — potential supply contraction in the £10K–£30K fee tier.
- Not This Time (Taylor Made Stallions) now standing at US\$250,000 — from crops bred at US\$40–45K; his trajectory validates the 'buy early' thesis.
- SAFE Act momentum in US Congress — industry self-regulation window closing; watch for state-level legislation if federal continues to stall.
- Consolidation of digital auction platforms — Fasig-Tipton, Tattersalls Online and Inglis Digital competing for the same dispersal/rotation market.
- Inbreeding coefficient data entering mainstream commercial conversations — expect Weatherbys and equivalents to publish COI data alongside pedigrees within 2–3 seasons.
- Second generation of Galileo-line and Wootton Bassett-line sires (Camille Pissarro, Henri Matisse) — sons entering stud in 2026 with elite Flat credentials across France, Ireland and UK.

This report was prepared by the BloodstockAI Research Division using published data from TDN (Thoroughbred Daily News), BloodHorse, TTR Aus/NZ, Breednet, Thoroughbred Racing Commentary, Magic Millions, Inglis, OBS, Tattersalls, TBA and primary industry sources including Gainesway, Juddmonte, Darley, Coolmore, Taylor Made Stallions and Haras de Beaumont. Estimated figures are noted as such. This document is intended exclusively for equine industry professionals for market analysis purposes. Nothing herein constitutes investment or financial advice.

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